

Subject: Work Placement / Project Alternative Module and Credits

Dear student,

There are a number of options available to H.Dip candidates to satisfy the 'Work Placement / Project Alternative' component of the H.Dip programmes. An overview of these is detailed below; please consider each option carefully to determine which is the appropriate option for you.

Regardless of the option selected to earn the credits, please note that this module ('Work Placement or Project Alternative') is not "scored" (*i.e.* a % mark is not awarded); it is either passed or it is not (*i.e.* you have either achieved the work placement learning outcomes or you have not). The classification of your final H.Dip award is thus based on your scores across the ten taught (and examined) modules only.

The anticipated learning outcomes of the Work Placement / Project module of the H.Dip. programmes are the following:

1. ***Work efficiently and effectively on a project as part of a team.***
2. ***Contribute to the strategy of the team in achieving project goals.***
3. ***Explain the business strategy or the core business of an employer and how the team's work relates to it.***
4. ***Work autonomously on specified tasks relating to a project.***

It should be noted that this is an ***experiential*** module, not a *skills acquisition* module (you acquired new skills as part of the ten formally taught and examined modules).

There are five options to achieving the learning outcomes; choose the one option that best suits your circumstances.

Further details on any of the options detailed below can be obtained by emailing the team looking after the HDip Placement/Project module at:

hdip-placement-computerscience.galwaymayo@atu.ie

The same contact address may also be used when seeking any further advice.

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Option 1 – Preparation for Work or Work Placement.

- *This is a project element to satisfy the H.Dip. Work Placement / Project Alternative module requirements and to prepare candidates for obtaining work or a work placement.*

This alternative is suited to candidates who:

- Are currently out of work and are looking for work or a work placement position.
- Are in work but are looking for a new career path in the near future.

Summary of Steps involved in this option:

1. Candidates enroll for and complete ***The Next Steps Transitioning to Work*** module.
2. Candidates complete a **Professional Portfolio**.
3. Candidates engage with the **ATU Careers Service** with a view to obtaining a placement.
4. If Project/Placement Team is satisfied with the completion of the above steps, the credits are then awarded for the module.

Option 2 - New Work Placement/Internship or New Employment Role.

- *This involves the candidate undertaking a new employment/placement/internship role to satisfy the H.Dip. Work Placement / Project Alternative module requirements.*

This alternative is suited to candidates who:

- Have identified or can easily identify, a work placement/internship opportunity that they can avail of.
- Have identified or can easily identify, an employment role, either part-time or full-time, that they can avail of.

Summary of Steps involved in this option:

1. Candidates start placement/internship/employment.
2. When a sufficient period of placement/employment time has elapsed (*e.g.* ~160 hours, or perhaps longer), and the module learning outcomes have been deemed to be achieved, the candidate's supervisor/employer communicates with the Placement/Project team expressing their professional opinion that this is the case.
3. If Project/Placement Team is satisfied, the credits are then awarded for the module.

Option 3 - Using existing workplace / current working role.

- *This involves the candidate using their current employment role in a workplace to satisfy the H.Dip. Work Placement / Project Alternative module requirements.*

This option is suited to candidates who:

- Are currently employed and are happy in their current working role, and where their current work allows them to achieve the four learning outcomes of the H.Dip Work Placement / Project module.
- Are currently employed and are happy in their current working role, but can move to a position / project (perhaps temporarily) with their current employer that allows them to achieve the four learning outcomes of the Placement / Project module.

Summary of Steps involved in this option:

1. Candidates start their period of employment that they are going to use to fulfil the module requirements.
2. When a sufficient period of employment time has elapsed (*e.g.* ~160 hours, or perhaps longer), and the module learning outcomes have been deemed to be achieved, the candidate's supervisor/employer communicates with the Placement/Project team expressing their professional opinion that this is the case.
3. If the Project/Placement Team is satisfied, the credits are then awarded for the module.

Option 4 - Using previous employment / working role / experience to meet requirements.

- *This involves the candidate using a previous employment / working role / work experience to satisfy the H.Dip. Work Placement / Project Alternative module requirements.*

This alternative is suited to candidates who:

- Have already achieved the four learning outcomes, as detailed below, associated with the Work Placement / Project module and can demonstrate this to be the case.

Summary of Steps involved in this option:

- 1(a) The candidate's current or former employer/supervisor emails the Placement/Project Team expressing the view that, based on their evaluation of your previous employment/work performance/experience, they are of the professional opinion that you have already achieved the four learning outcomes of the Work Placement / Project module.
- 1(b). Or the candidate, submits documentation demonstrating how their career / employment experiences (either current, or past, or both) have allowed them to achieve the four learning outcomes for the Work Placement / Project module.
2. If Project/Placement Team is satisfied, the credits are then awarded for the module.

Option 5 - Using existing workplace / current employment plus project work.

- *Here details are provided as to how a current (or previous) employment role in a workplace may be used in conjunction with assigned project work to satisfy the H.Dip. Work Placement / Project Alternative module requirements.*

This option is suited to candidates who:

- Are currently employed and are happy in their current working role, but where they have determined that they would need to complete some assigned project work in addition to their current (or a previous) employment role to enable them to achieve the four learning outcomes of the H.Dip Work Placement / Project module.

Summary of Steps involved in this option:

1. Candidates start their period of employment that they are going to use to fulfil the module requirements. Note that candidates can also use a previous employment period and role here, instead of a period of employment starting and going forward.
2. When a sufficient period of employment time has elapsed (e.g. ~160 hours, or perhaps longer), and the module learning outcomes have been deemed to be achieved, the candidate's supervisor/employer communicates with the Placement/Project team expressing their professional opinion that this is the case.
3. Candidates complete a **Professional Portfolio** that includes additional project work if deemed necessary.
4. If the Project/Placement Team is satisfied with the outcome of the above steps, the credits are then awarded for the module.